全民英檢中級 GEPT Intermediate | 第 43 單元 | 時間與變化 · Time & Change

Grandma's Tea Shop Gets a Second Life

奶奶的茶行重獲新生

October 18, Saturday. Lately I have been thinking a lot about Grandma's tea shop in Dadaocheng. It has stood on the same street corner for more than six decades, and until last year, it opened punctually at eight every morning, just as it had when my great-grandfather ran it. But nowadays few young people stop by, and sales have declined year after year. The wooden door has begun to decay, and the red paint on the sign has faded. At dusk, the shop looks like something from a different era.

This afternoon, my cousin Mei-ling, who studies design in Taichung, arrived with a surprising plan. Instead of letting the business cease, she wants to transform it gradually into a tea cafe where customers can taste traditional tea and also take photos for social media. Grandma's initial reaction was silence. Then she asked whether the old tea jars would remain. "Of course," Mei-ling said. "We will renew the space, but the origin of the shop will stay the same." Meanwhile, I was doing the math in my head: the renovation would be temporary, lasting about two months, and the shop could reopen in time for its sixty-fifth anniversary in January.

Grandma did not say yes immediately. She said she needed to adapt to the idea first and asked us to postpone the decision for a week. Afterwards, while we were washing the cups, she admitted something I had never heard before: the shop has changed many times in her lifetime, from selling rice to selling tea, and every change seemed frightening at first. "Nothing is permanent," she said, "but the things we love can evolve." I think she will eventually agree. In the meantime, I am going to take photos of every corner of the shop, so that whatever happens, the memory of this version will not fade.

重點單字 Key Vocabulary

單字	詞性	中文	例句
decade	*n.*	十年	My parents have lived in Taipei for two decades. 我的父母在台北住了二十年。

decline	*v.*	下降；衰退	The number of visitors declined sharply last winter. 去年冬天遊客人數大幅下降。
decay	*v.*	腐爛；腐朽	The fallen leaves slowly decayed on the ground. 落葉在地上慢慢腐爛。
fade	*v.*	褪色；逐漸消失	The colors of the old photo have faded. 這張舊照片的顏色已經褪了。
transform	*v.*	改變；轉變	The factory was transformed into an art center. 這座工廠被改造成藝術中心。
initial	*adj.*	最初的；開始的	My initial plan was to study abroad. 我最初的計畫是出國念書。
renew	*v.*	更新；翻新	I need to renew my library card next month. 我下個月需要更新我的借書證。
postpone	*v.*	延期；延後	The game was postponed because of the rain. 比賽因為下雨而延期。
permanent	*adj.*	永久的	He finally got a permanent job at the bank. 他終於在銀行得到一份固定的工作。
evolve	*v.*	演變；逐漸發展	The small blog evolved into a popular website. 這個小部落格演變成一個受歡迎的網站。

片語 Phrases

stop by	順道拜訪	Feel free to stop by my office anytime. 隨時歡迎順道來我的辦公室。
year after year	年復一年	The birds return to the island year after year. 這些鳥年復一年地回到島上。
in the meantime	在此期間；同時	The bus comes at six; in the meantime, let's get a drink. 公車六點來；在這期間，我們去買杯飲料吧。

文法與句型 Grammar

Instead of + V-ing / N, S + V

instead of 是介系詞片語，後面接動名詞或名詞，表示「而不是…、代替…」。

Instead of taking the bus, we walked to the night market.

我們沒有搭公車，而是走路去夜市。

S + ask / wonder + whether + S + V

whether 引導名詞子句作為受詞，表示「是否…」，常用於間接問句，子句要用直述句的語序。

She asked whether the old tea jars would remain.

她問那些舊茶罐會不會留下來。

讀完文章後，請到「皇家大衛英文閱讀集點站」完成本單元測驗，答對即可累積點數。